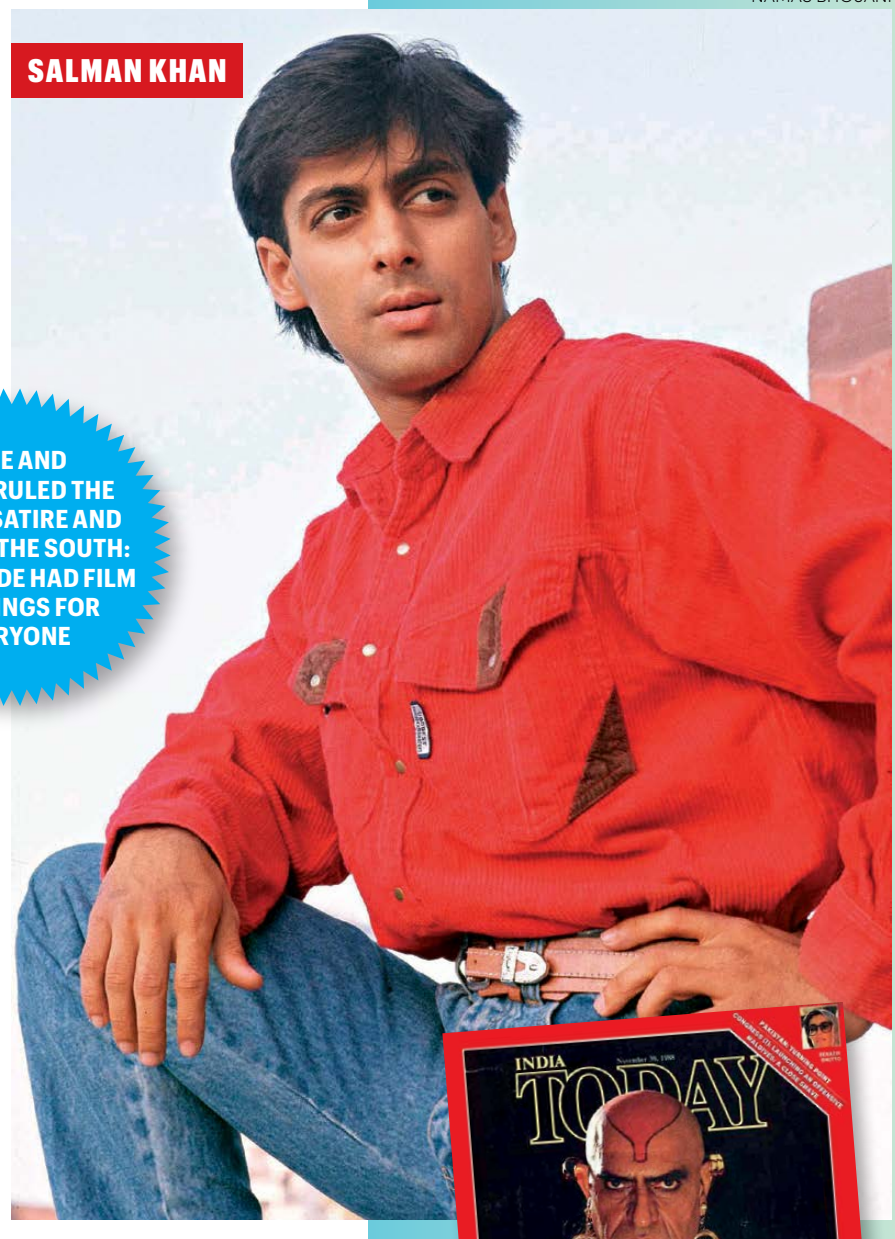
PRAMOD PUSHKARNA

NAMAS BHOJANI



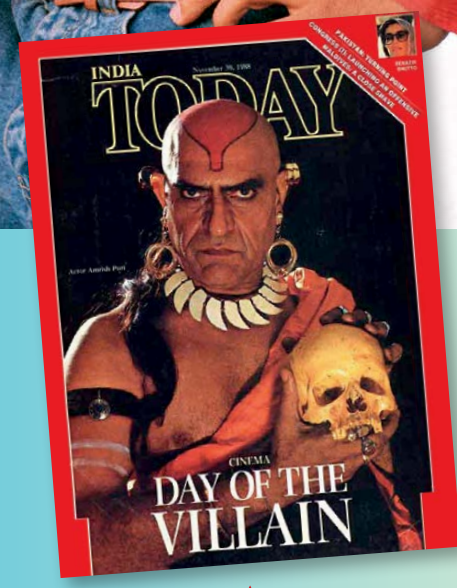


SALMAN KHAN

LOVE AND FAMILY RULED THE NORTH, SATIRE AND REALISM THE SOUTH: THE DECADE HAD FILM OFFERINGS FOR EVERYONE

to break ground, with Delhi lad Shah Rukh taking his time to get to *Baazigar* via *Deewana*. High romance was in vogue and all three had big hits with titles like *Hum Aapke Hain Koun* (the 1994 Salman film made it to the Rs 100 crore club then), *Dil* (Aamir) and *Deewana* (Shah Rukh). For relief, there was Shekhar Kapoor's *Mr India*, a one-off foray into the fantastic that charmed audiences with the vanishing Anil Kapoor (and ravishing Sridevi), as also Vidhu Vinod Chopra's crime noir *Parinda*.

It was not immediately apparent, but the classic Hindi film of old was dying out. In terms of sheer film-making energies, the impetus shifted to the South—they had that exuberant knack for taking raw material, the feel for story, character, satire, an undercurrent of social realism or plain poppycock, and turning it all into lip-smacking cinematic juice. Mani Ratnam, Ram Gopal Varma et al ushered in a new template that would soon be a wake-up call for Bollywood. In fact, Ratnam—with a movie almost every year of the decade, *Nayakan* (1987)



DAY OF THE VILLAIN
Nov. 30, 1988

"Below, on Bombay's ferry docks, people push their fists through the iron bars and cheer lustily: "Mogambo, Mogambo, say Mogambo *khush hua*." Amrish Puri, the Shahenshah of the expanding kingdom of villainy, turns and waves, like a benevolent dictator to the up-turned faces of the masses..."